Field Notes on Water Use

Why the meters matter

Each district now reports its daily use, and the morning figures go to the regional office before noon. The office compares them with last year's and marks any district that rose by more than a tenth.

- Read the meter at the same hour each day
- Write the reading in the district log
- Send the log to the office before noon

The pilot ran in three districts during the dry months, and the readers found that most of the rise came from leaks in old pipes rather than from new users. Two of the districts replaced their worst pipes within a season, and their daily use fell back to the level of the year before. The third district is still waiting for its budget, so its readings stay high and its log is checked twice a week by the regional office.

What changes next year

From the spring, every district will send its log through the new form. The paper log stays as a copy for the district itself, and the form asks for the reading, the hour and the name of the reader.

Questions about the form go to the office's help desk.